

Cell Phones

Smartphones

Sony-Ericsson K700i

Specs: 65K colour screen, 41 MB built-in, tri-band, VGA Camera, Bluetooth and MP3 audio

Our Verdict: The K700i comes in a beautifully crafted body accentuated by the anodised silver finish. The translucent keypad, though cramped, gels perfectly with the body. The K700i from Sony-Ericsson is unarguably the most feature-rich phone in its category; name the feature and it's got it.

With features cramped into its small body, the K700i wins over its closest com-

petitors on the features it offers. The K700i comes with a brilliant 65K colour screen. The menu interface is sleek, and the browsing action is crisp without significant lag or jerks. The inbuilt camera is good for casual shots, and returns above-par picture quality. The MP3 player, though lacking in fidelity, comes in handy when on the move. Bluetooth makes transferring files and syncing your data a piece of cake.



Runner-up: Nokia 6600

Colour Laser Printers

Lexmark C510

Specs: 30 PPM mono printouts, 8 PPM colour printouts, 2400 dpi image, 500 Hz processor and 64 MB buffer memory.

Our Verdict: The C510 from Lexmark is an entry-level colour laser targeted at the price conscious, small workgroup. Boasting 30 mono and eight colour printouts per minute, the C510 lives up to expectations. The optional Ethernet adapter allows you to connect the printer to your network. Other good features are the 64 MB buffer memory (upgradeable to 320 MB for heavy

duty use), a 250 sheet paper cassette, an optional duplexing unit and more! The C510 from Lexmark printed 24 mono pages, which is pretty close to the rated 30 PPM; colour printing was not up to the mark, though. The quality of printing was also much better than the competition.

Runner-up:

Samsung CLP-500



Digital Cameras

Under 30,000 rupees

Kodak Dx-6490

Specs: 4 Megapixels, 10X optical zoom, 38-380 focal length, 1/1700–16 shutter speed and 16 MB memory

Our Verdict: The Kodak DX-6490 sports a pseudo-SLR look. The potential highlight of this camera is the 10X optical zoom engine that can zero in on to distant objects. The camera also has a small EVF (Electronic View Finder) which, when used, boosts the battery life to certain

extent. The quality of the output is crisp, vibrant and life-like. For the price it is offered at, the DX-6490 is a great buy.

It features in this list for its picture quality, features offered and for its excellent ergonomics.



Runner-up:

Sony Cybershot P100

Flashback To December 2000

ClickiT DCE-400 Digital Camera

Specs: 1,024x768, 4 MB CF card, USB, 4 AA batteries

Evolution: In 2000, digital photography was just taking its roots in India, and the ClickiT DCE-400 is a perfect example. The ClickiT DCE-400 was priced at Rs 20,000, and all it could do was take images at 1024x768 or 640x480, and could probably take it at 1.5 megapixels. In four years, digital photography has come a long way and cameras much better than the ClickiT DCE-400 cost no more than Rs 10,000. Today, for Rs 20,000, you can expect a camera with a 4-megapixel CCD, 3x optical zoom, 4x digital

zoom and other advanced features including white-balance, etc.

Pioneer DVD-1045Z

Specs: CD read 40x, DVD read 10x

Evolution: In 2000, DVD-ROM drives were the happening things: fast-forward to 2004, and we see DVD writers as the next big wave. Today, the Pioneer DVR-108 not only allows reading DVD disks but also burning 4.3 GB of data onto a single disk. With dual-layer DVD drives making it to the market, you can soon write double that amount onto a single DVD.

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